



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES PRESENTS



START HERE

The Secret Santa Murder

An Office Christmas Party Murder Mystery Game

8-40 PLAYERS

TEAM PLAY

60 MIN OR 2 HRS

PRINTABLE PDF



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES

US LETTER + A4 · 23 PDFs

Read Me First

HOST ONLY · 5 MINUTES

Two identical folders: **US-Letter** and **A4**. Print from the one that matches your paper.

FILE	WHAT IT IS	WHO GETS IT
00 START-HERE	This guide: files, player counts, print list, FAQ	Host (read on screen)
01 Host-Guide	Checklist, casting, team play, timelines, Scripts 1–4, tips	Host · 1 copy
02 Manager-Approval	One page to send your manager or HR	Your approver
03 Invitations	10 suspect invitations, guest invitation, email + Slack/Teams text	Optional
04 Cast-List	Public who's-who of all 10 suspects and Bart	Everyone may read
10–19 Suspect-...	One 4-page booklet per suspect (10–15 core, 16–19 optional)	Each suspect, only their own
20 Combined	All 10 booklets in one file, for one-click printing	Print it, don't read it
21 Party-Guest-Cards	20 guest cards (G1–G20) + dealing instructions	One per non-suspect guest
30 Evidence-Cards	12 evidence cards (E1–E12), card backs, blank cards	Evidence table
31 Name-Tags	39 name tags (suspects, guests, Detective, blanks)	Everyone
32 Team-Case-File	2-page worksheet for each detective team	1 per team
33 Accusation-Ballots	4 ballots per page + scoring	1 per team (or player)
34 Awards-and-Table-Signs	3 award certificates, Team 1–6 signs, evidence sign	Optional
99 SOLUTION-Host-Only	The answer, clue chain and final Script 5	Host · open at the reveal

DO NOT OPEN 99 UNTIL THE REVEAL

You don't need the answer to run the game, so you can solve it too. Print 99 last, unread, and keep it sealed until Script 5.

Players & Printing

CHOOSE YOUR ROW

❄ How many are coming?

PLAYERS	SUSPECTS	GUEST CARDS	DETECTIVE TEAMS
8–10	8–10 (6 core + optional)	none	none: everyone plays solo
11–30	all 10	one per extra guest, G1 → G20 in order	3–6 teams of 4–8
31–40	all 10	all 20; extra guests join teams without a card	6 teams, max 8 per team

❄ Print list (pages to print)

PLAYERS	BOOKLETS	GUEST CARDS	TEAMS	NAME-TAG PAGES	21 PAGES	CASE FILES + BALLOTS	SUM OF PAGES	TOTAL	CARDS TO CUT
8	8 booklets	—	0	2	—	0 + 2	16+5+2+32+2+2+2	61	36
12	10	G1–G2	3	2	2 (p1–2)	3×2 + 1	16+5+2+40+2+2+2+6+1	76	34
20	10	G1–G10	4	3	6 (p1–6)	4×2 + 1	16+5+2+40+6+2+3+8+1	83	50
30	10	G1–G20	5	4	11	5×2 + 2	16+5+2+40+11+2+4+10+2	92	72
40	10	G1–G20 (+10 no card)	6	5 + p5 again	11	6×2 + 2	16+5+2+40+11+2+6+12+2	96	86

Every row includes 01 Host Guide (16), 99 Solution (5), 04 Cast List (2), booklets (4 each), 30 Evidence pages 1–2 (2), the name-tag pages shown, 32 Case File (2 per team) and 33 Ballots (1 page = 4). "Cards to cut" = guest cards + 12 evidence cards + name tags + ballots.

OPTIONAL EXTRAS (NOT IN THE TOTALS)

00 Start Here (4 pages, read on screen) · 02 Approval (1) · 03 Invitations (7) · 30 card backs and blank cards (2) · 34 Awards and table signs (7). File 20 (40 pages) replaces the 10 separate booklets if you prefer one print job.

PRINTER SETTINGS

Print at 100% / "Actual size", not "Fit to page". Black-and-white is fine: every clue, frame and cut line stays clear in grayscale. Card stock is nice for name tags and signs but not required.

Questions Before You Start

Does anyone have to act?

No. Suspects read prompts from their booklets, and guest detectives simply chat, compare notes and vote. Shy players can stay on a team the whole time.

Is it office-appropriate?

Yes. It is rated PG: no gore, no romance, no drinking tasks and no jokes about real colleagues. Motives are money, credit and promotions.

Do the roles work for any gender?

Yes. Every suspect and guest name is gender-neutral and the booklets use names, not he/she.

Can the host play?

The host plays Detective Sam Holloway and runs the game. Because 99 stays sealed until the end, you can try to solve it too.

We only have an hour.

Use the Lunch-Hour Express timeline in the Host Guide (60–75 minutes). Send booklets to suspects two days ahead.

Some people canceled at the last minute.

Optional suspects 16–19 can be dropped (see the Host Guide table). Guest cards are dealt in order, and the Host Guide lists the four lines to read aloud if key cards weren't dealt.

Can people join remotely?

The game is designed for one room. The Host Guide has a short, honest note on including a remote team.

NEED HELP?

Email hello@clueandcandlegames.com. If the game doesn't work for your party, ask for a refund within 14 days of purchase.

A NOTE ON HOW THIS GAME WAS MADE

The story, characters and clues were written with the help of AI writing tools, then edited, fact-checked for fair-play logic and laid out by the Clue & Candle Games team. All people and companies in this game, including Evergreen & Pine Co., are fictional.